

THE WEST AFRICAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

BASIC EDUCATION CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION -- JUNE 2008

ENGLISH LANGUAGE -- PAPER 2

Duration: 1 Hour 15 Minutes | Level: JHS 3 / BECE | Code: ENG 01/02 - P2

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

Answer two questions in all: one from Part A and the compulsory question in Part B.

PART II: ESSAY & STRUCTURED QUESTIONS WITH WAEC RUBRICS

QUESTION 1: Part A: Essay Writing (Choose One)

Candidates are required to write an essay of about 250 words on one of the following topics.

- (a) Write a letter to your friend in another school describing a sports festival recently organized in your school and how your house performed. [30 marks]**

Model Answer / WAEC Rubric: Rubric: Content (10 marks) - Greeting, date, introduction, vivid description of sports events, cheerfulness, outcome/trophy. Organization (10 marks) - Informal letter format, paragraphing, coherent transitions. Expression (10 marks) - Variety of vocabulary, idiomatic expressions, correct punctuation and spelling. [A10, B10, M10]

- (b) Write an article for publication in your school magazine on the topic: "The negative effects of illicit mining (galamsey) on our environment." [30 marks]**

Model Answer / WAEC Rubric: Rubric: Title and byline. Paragraphs discussing water pollution (Pra, Birim rivers), loss of arable farm land, open pits endangering lives, and recommendations for enforcement and reclamation. [A10, B10, M10]

QUESTION 2: Part B: Reading Comprehension

Read the following passage carefully and answer all the questions that follow:

"From the hilltop, the old fisherman watched the dark clouds gather ominously over the Atlantic ocean. The wind began to blow in sudden, violent gusts, tossing the anchored canoes against the wooden pier. In the coastal village of Anomabo, storms during the month of June were known to bring both destruction and blessing. While heavy downpours filled empty community reservoirs, turbulent waters prevented fishermen from venturing into the deep sea for weeks. Young Kojo, clutching his father's hand, gazed at the foam-crested waves and asked why nature could be so cruel yet so indispensable."

- (a) What sign warned the old fisherman of an approaching storm? [3 marks]**

Model Answer / WAEC Rubric: The gathering of ominous dark clouds over the Atlantic ocean and violent gusts of wind tossing the canoes. [A3]

- (b) Why was the storm described as both a destruction and a blessing? [4 marks]**

Model Answer / WAEC Rubric: It was a blessing because downpours filled dry community reservoirs, but a destruction because turbulent waters prevented fishing for weeks, depriving them of livelihood. [A4]

- (c) Explain the meaning of the word "indispensable" as used in the passage. [3 marks]**

Model Answer / WAEC Rubric: Indispensable means absolutely essential, necessary, or impossible to do without. [A3]